- *Event category*—The category may be any string value, but it's typically set to the name of the class creating the log. For `ILogger<T>`, the full name of the type `T` is the category.
- *Message*—This is the content of the log message. It can be a static string, or it can contain placeholders for variables, as shown in listing 26.2. Placeholders are indicated by braces, `{}` and are replaced by the provided parameter values.
- *Parameters*—If the message contains placeholders, they're associated with the provided parameters. For the example in listing 26.2, the value of `Recipes.Count` is assigned to the placeholder called `RecipeCount`. Some loggers can extract these values and expose them in your logs, as you'll see in section 26.5.
- *Exception*—If an exception occurs, you can pass the exception object to the logging function along with the message and other parameters. The logger records the exception in addition to the message itself.
- *EventId*—This is an optional integer identifier for the error, which can be used to quickly find all similar logs in a series of log messages. You might use an `EventId` of `1000` when a user attempts to load a non-existent recipe and an `EventId` of `1001` when a user attempts to access a recipe they don't have permission to access. If you don't provide an `EventId`, the value `0` is used.